



Parasha Va'yeilech – Shuvah Yisrael (Return Israel)

(Deuteronomy 31:1 – 31:30)

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Parasha Va'yeilech is a very short portion; however its message remains pertinent to our generation. The portion primarily speaks to Yehoshua (Joshua) being chosen to lead in place of Moses and highlights that in deed Yisrael will inherit the promised. It encouraged Yisrael not to be afraid but to remember the past victory. The portion then segues dramatically into a prelude of a *shirah* (song) which Moses is being told to write, and teach to *Yisrael*. Which song we will read in the next portion (*Haazinu – Hebrew for Listen*), which is a song meant to act as a witness:

“Therefore, write down this poem and teach it to the people of Israel; put it in their mouths, in order that this poem may be My witness against the people of Israel.”

[Deuteronomy 31:19]

The *shirah* will speak in strong language what would be later recorded in the book of the Kings and the books of the Prophets (See example: 2 Kings 25:22-26 and Jeremiah 39:13-14; 40:1-41:18) which record events which had happened around 597 B.C.E.. Some two hundred years prior to this *Am Yisrael* in the Kingdom of Yisrael would have been exposed to Tiglath-Pileser and Sargon (1 Chronicles 5:26, 2 Kings 15:29, 2 Kings 17:6-7 and 2 Kings 17:18-20).

Segment of the Judean population would later begin to returned some 70 years later (See: Jeremiah 25, Daniel 9, the book of Ezra and the book of Nehemiah) and endured in the land fighting off various onslaught, and amidst various changing geo-political struggles. Some of the most pressing struggles being that of the Macedonian onslaught (some 300 years after), the attacks by Pompey (some 100 years after the Macedonians), the attacks of Gaius Cassius Longinus (some 10 years after) and some 120 years later the sacking by Titus and over the next 80 years, the struggles with Hadrian and later Antoninus Pius. By then, Jerusalem would was wholly loss and so too the Beit HaMikdash.

The *shirah* Moses was told to sing has remained true. What makes it even truer is not only the clarity which it spoke to the demise which would happen to all of our forefathers who strayed but that in His Mercy, **Yah will return the remnant** and will measure out justice on all those who had partook in the oppression of *Am Yisrael*. (See Isaiah 62: 11-12, 63: 1-19, 65: 8-9 and Deuteronomy 32:36, 32:39, 32:43)

The formation of the Modern State of Israel, presents clearer indication of the redemption which the *shirah* in *Haazinu* will likewise addressed. The *Haazinu shirah*, speaks to the scattered of **Am Yisrael (the people of Israel)** throughout the Latin Americas, the Caribbean and in other places – who forms a part of the promise.

Am Yisrael in our repentance must remember our first love (See *Jeremiah 2*) and must recall the word of God spoken through the Prophet Isaiah saying:

אני יהוה הוא שמי וכבודי לאחר לא־אתן ותהלתי לפסילים
“I am יהוה, that is My name; I will not yield My glory to another, Nor My renown to idols.”
[Isaiah 42:8]

All it takes is for Israel to remember our first Love...and to cast aside all imagery of wood and stone (these are symbolism: since wood also speaks to trusting in an object which was made from the tree, its derivatives and or hangings; and similarly for stone which can be extrapolated to trusting or elevating humans (king or peasants) to a god, since, (the son of Adam) man’s original genesis is dust) and Return to יהוה who made the Heaven and Earth and all that is within.

“Elijah approached all the people and said, “How long will you keep hopping between two opinions? If יהוה is God, then follow יהוה ; and if Baal, follow Baal!” [1 Kings 18:21]

יהוה הוא האלהים יהוה הוא האלהים
“יהוה alone is God, יהוה alone is God!”
[1 Kings 18:39]

Shabbat Shalom